



knockouts finish might not be the worst 'small' ambition to have. Those little bricks of belief helped New Zealand build something special in a city that knows a thing or two about constructing wonders.

Twenty-four years ago, Emily Drumm and Debbie Hockley's White Ferns pulled off a four-wicket win over Australia to lift the ODI World title at home in 2000. It was a different era, when Australia, England, and New Zealand were the primary cricketing powers, while the likes of India were managing small acts of defiance, but nothing comprehensive enough to upset the established order.

Jubilant scenes: An ecstatic Sophie Devine (centre), poses with teammates Lea Tahuhu (left) and Suzie Bates (right) with the trophy. AP

Fast forward to the present, and these traditional powers now face the challenge of women's cricket improving worldwide, with margins of competition narrowing rapidly, particularly in the last five years.

Back to the roots

Once the Kiwi huddle was done and the victory was discussed, Amelia Kerr — the player of the final and the tournament, the first to earn